

RFI 10887-25

Questions and Answers

Enterprise Data Management Solution

The purpose of this document is to provide questions and answers regarding this RFI. The following Q&As are current as of **12/8/2025**:

Q1: Can companies from Outside USA apply for this? (from India or Canada)

A1: There is no limitation, however we will expect any partner to comply with our Information, Privacy, and Security Agreement (IPSA) section 5.c:

Use, Storage, or Access to, City Data. C. Unless specifically authorized in writing by City, Consultant shall not (i) access, store, process, transmit, or create City Data at locations outside the fifty (50) United States of America; (ii) permit viewing access to City Data by Consultant or any of its agents (including any subconsultants) or any other person outside the fifty (50) United States of America through any screen sharing technology such as Remote Desktop Protocol or VMware Remote Console ("VMRC"), or other current or future protocols designed to provide similar functionality; or (iii) provide City Data received from, created, or received by Vendor on behalf of City to any employee or agent, including a subconsultant, if such employee, agent, or subconsultant receives, processes, or otherwise has access to such City Data outside of the fifty (50) United States of America. The prohibitions set forth in this Section 5.c apply not only to Consultant's data center locations and personnel primarily involved with providing the contracted Services, but equally to any and all data centers and personnel used for resilience or redundancy, backups, log storage, after-hours support, and any downstream partners that may access, store, process, transmit, or create City Data.

Q2: Do we need to attend meetings in person, or can they be held remotely?

A2: We don't anticipate requiring on-site meetings

Q3: 3. Can we perform the tasks (related to RFP) outside USA? (from India or Canada)

A3: Please note this solicitation is not an RFP, this is RFI – Request for Information.



This RFI is issued for information gathering purposes only. The City does not intend to award a contract at the end of this process. New RFP will be issued sometime in the future when the City is ready to award.

This is covered under the IPSA section 5.c:

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Q4: Can we submit the proposals via email?

A4: No. Please refer to submittal instructions on the solicitation page.

Q5: From the responses the City receives from this RFI, does the City intend to issue a final RFP or is it the intent to work off these RFI responses to narrow down the vendors and then select one of the respondents?

A5: Based on information received City will issue an RFP and invite all respondents of this RFI to submit proposals.

Q6: Can the City share if they have been working with any vendors and their specific products/solutions to help determine the City's needs for this solution?

A6: This is the beginning of the effort to understand solution options and no specific products/vendors have been evaluated at this point. All discussions have been internal to the City.

Q7: With the holidays and many people out on vacations this week and next, to provide our best response from our technical and bid teams, could the response due date be extended out 1 week?



A7: Yes, we can extend the close date to December 17.

Q8: For terms & conditions in this response, is it the City's intent to choose a vendor based on their response and then review and agree to the SLAs and legal terms & conditions?

A8: Yes, our process to determine production SLA's and agree to terms and conditions will happen during final selections and not as part of this RFI effort.

Q9: Are you required to use GCC (Government Cloud) or can you use commercial?

A9: We are in GCC so we want solutions that work in GCC. Long term we are considering moving to Commercial Cloud. But for now, we require GCC even though we know there are limitations.

Q10: What are the top three business problems or pain points the City expects this platform to solve within the first 12–18 months?

A10: 1) Collection of disparate data from multiple sources into a common repository in order to better utilize the data we have, 2) create a platform for future data collection, 3) create a process/template for data collection in the future so that new sources can be added to existing stores

Q11: How mature is the City's current data governance framework, and what gaps in metadata, ownership, or lifecycle management are driving this initiative?

A11: The City's data governance framework is emerging but not yet mature. We have policies, roles, and standards in draft, but gaps in consistent metadata, clear data ownership, and lifecycle management—especially for data that lives outside enterprise systems—are driving the need for a more structured and scalable solution.

Q12: For integrations with systems such as EnerGov, Dynamics 365, UKG, and ESRI, does the City anticipate real-time data exchange, scheduled syncs, or API-level orchestration?

A12: The City primarily anticipates scheduled syncs for integrations with EnerGov, Dynamics 365, UKG, and ESRI. While real-time exchange is not a core requirement, we do expect reliable, repeatable API-level integration patterns that support our enterprise data lake and reporting workflows.

Q13: What level of departmental autonomy does the City envision—will departments build their own forms/workflows, or will configuration be managed centrally by IT?



A13: We envision a hybrid model: departments should have the autonomy to build simple forms and workflows, but within a centrally governed framework. TIS will manage the platform configuration, standards, and data structures to ensure quality, security, and alignment with our data lake and Power BI processes

Q14: What challenges has the City encountered with Power BI that the new platform should specifically address (e.g., data refresh delays, access control, accuracy, dataset ownership)?

A14: Power BI itself is not the issue—our challenges arise when data isn't stored in an enterprise system. Today, many datasets live in personal drives, OneDrive, SharePoint, or ad-hoc spreadsheets, which creates accuracy, access, and refresh risks. We need a platform that centralizes and manages this non-enterprise data so it can flow into our governed data lake and be reported through our existing enterprise Power BI framework

Q15: How does the City plan to measure success for this project? Are there specific adoption, performance, or governance outcomes that would define a successful implementation?

A15: We will consider the project successful when departments consistently use the platform instead of personal files, data is centrally managed with clear ownership and metadata, and reporting becomes more accurate and timelier. Strong adoption, streamlined workflows, and alignment with our enterprise data governance standards are key indicators of success.

Q16: Is participation in this RFI required to participate in the future RFP?

A16: No, the RFI is not a prerequisite for any future RFP.

Q17: Could the City extend the RFI submission deadline?

A17: We will extend the RFI to 12/31/2025

Q18: Could the firms provide commercial references?

A18: Yes

Q19: Should response be submitted as a single PDF?

A19: Yes

Q20: Is there any page limit for the response?

A20: No



Q21: Are references from ongoing contracts accepted?

A21: Yes

Q22: Please clarify what information vendors should add in the section Questions for the City—issues requiring clarification to tailor their response?

A22: This section is optional; this is a space for questions to help tailor feature RFP.

Q23: In case firms are submitting confidential information in the response, is it required to provide a redacted version?

Q23 No. Please refer to Public Disclosure Notice, page 4 of the RFI

Q24: Should bidders include 'Questions for the City' in the RFI response itself, or only submit them during the pre-submission Q&A window?

A24: Either way is fine.

Q25: Could the City please share the anticipated timeline for issuing the formal RFP following this RFI process?

A25: We do not currently have a timeline for the formal RFP

Q26: Does the City have a preferred pricing template or format for presenting rate cards and deliverables-based fees at this RFI stage?

A26: No preference

Q27: Given the limited scope details, would you prefer pricing as ranges for roles and milestones, or single-point estimates?

A27: Ranges are fine

Q28: Is it acceptable to include explicit pricing assumptions (e.g., estimated number of integrations, datasets, and phases) in the pricing section of the RFI response?

A28: Yes

Q29: Are there GCC specific licensing or connector costs bidders should reflect in the pricing, or will the City handle those under existing agreements?



A29: Please include any licensing and connectors needed for solution and associated costs in a separate line item.

Q30: As IPSC §5.c prohibits any access or viewing of City Data outside the fifty (50) United States, should bidders assume that all project resources must be U.S.-based?

A30: The City has the ability to approve offshore resources if required by the project

Q31: Would City like a deliverables-based fee table (fixed fees per milestone) alongside hourly/T&M rates, or is either format acceptable at the RFI stage?

A31: Either is acceptable – if using hourly/T&M rates please provide estimated hours

Q32: Can the City provide an inventory or estimate of the number of existing data repositories (e.g., Excel files, Access databases, SharePoint lists, departmental systems)?

A32: 50+

Q33: Does the City have established data governance policies, stewards, metadata standards, or data ownership models that the platform must support or enforce?

A33: We are currently developing data governance policies and standards and will share as part of the project.

Q34: Does the City maintain a centralized data catalog or metadata inventory today?

A34: No – it is on our roadmap. Looking at MS Purview

Q35: Does the City have defined data ownership for existing datasets?

A35: No – it is on our roadmap

Q36: What is the City's current cloud strategy: Microsoft Azure, hybrid cloud, or fully on-prem legacy systems?

A36: We are hybrid with both onsite and SAAS applications

Q37: Are there any restrictions on SaaS tools beyond data residency requirements?

A37: No other restrictions

Q38: Is the city preferring a COTS solution or a Custom One?



A38: Slight preference to COTS although we are open to custom applications if the support model is outlined as part of the proposal

Q39: Approximately how many users are expected to create forms, build workflows, or design applications?

A39: 20+

Q40: How many users will require mobile-first access for field operations?

A40: 50+

Q41: Has the City had past challenges with the adoption of new technology tools?

A41: Nothing notable

Q42: Will the City require audit trails at the field level, record level, or application level?

A42: Depends on application – to be safe all three may be required.

Q43: Do departments primarily need linear approval workflows or multi-branch logic with escalations?

A43: Primarily linear but sometimes multi-branch.

Q44: Does the City require automated document generation (letters, reports, permits, etc.)?

A44: Possibly

Q45: What is the City's current Power BI usage model: self-service BI, centralized dashboards, departmental reports?

A45: Primarily centralized, however moving to a federated model.

Q46: Are APIs available for the listed systems (EnerGov, D365, UKG, Esri, etc.), and are there any known integration limitations?

A46: We currently have DWH for these systems and the connectivity would be through them.

Q47: Are there legacy on-prem systems that do not support modern integration standards?



A47: No

Q48: Does the City expect a one-time migration of existing datasets, or ongoing import/synchronization?

A48: Preferred both – one time migration of existing datasets that can then be depreciated and possible ongoing imports from others

Q49: What level of complexity does the City anticipate for forms simple data capture, multi-step forms, conditional logic, dynamic lookups, or cross-department routing?

A49: Everything listed.

Q50: Will forms require advanced features such as file uploads, barcode scanning, geolocation, or photo capture?

A50: Everything listed.

Q51: For field staff, what workflow actions should be possible via mobile approval, data entry, and offline submissions?

A51: Everything listed.

Q52: Has a SAAS platform been selected?

A52: Not yet - this project may inform that decision

Q53: Is there a migration involved, or net new processes expected to be created with existing data?

A53: Both

Q54: Should there be a training component included in the project plan?

A54: Yes

Q55: Are there any existing power bi reports or other reports that need to be ported over into the solution

A55: No

Q56: Are there existing Power BI capacities already provisioned and or PPU licenses



A56: Yes

Q57: What is the estimated volume of data for the project?

Q57: 50+ datasets < 500GB

Q58: How many source systems are in scope for the project, is it more than the 4 listed?

A58: 50+ datasets. Datasets listed in the RFI were illustrative, not exhaustive

Q59: What type of data sources need to be considered (where is Excel and Access databases sourcing their data)

A59: Excel, Access and SharePoint are the system of record for the datasets

Q60: What are the data retention needs?

A60: Data retention will be required - may be different per data set based on applicable regulations

Q61: Are you using Azure Entra ID for user permission access today?

A61: Yes

Q62: How many users are expected to be on the platform?

A62: 200

Q63: Is there a desire to have a development and production and UAT environment?

A63: Yes, we would need a full stack solution

Q64: Do you have an urgency to move from an existing code base/ system?

A64: No, although we would like an efficient approach to migration

Q65: What is used today for source control? Is there a preference for alternatives?

A65: No current prescribed system - open to all recommendations

Q66: Is there opportunity for resource collaboration? Eg is there an expectation to work with employees on the solution?



A66: Yes, this will be a collaborative project with Technology and other City Department resources.

Q67: What source systems are currently in play for real time reporting?

A67: We are looking for a tool for storing our data and then allowing PowerBI to connect natively

Q68: Are any streaming service configured, such as Event Grid, Event Hub, Azure service bus?

A68: No

Q69: Are you considering power apps for this or a different tool, or Power automate?

A69: We are looking for recommendations

Q70: Is there an existing strategy in place or are you creating a new one?

A70: This project will work within the parameters of the City data strategy but will be a new component

Q71: Is the intention to land the unstructured data into a centralized repo, such as SharePoint, Lakehouse?

A71: We are looking for recommendations

Q72: What type of collaboration is expected?

A72: We expect teams to discuss and understand requirements, constraints, and recommendations

Q73: What types of events may trigger a notification? Please provide examples

A73: Examples include approvals and rule exceptions

Q74: Do you have a need for data masking for sensitive data?

A74: Potentially

Q75: Are these sources expected to make up a data enterprise warehouse?



A75: We already have DWH for our enterprise systems - this source is expected to work in conjunction with that data warehouse

Q76: Would this be a 1-time project or ad hoc process?

A76: One time to migrate data with ongoing compliance for new data sources.

Q77: What formats are desired?

A77: Excel, CSV

Q78: What is the expectation for sharing, emails, SharePoint?

A78: Standard Microsoft Office applications

Q79: Can you define data volume?

A79: 50+ datasets < 500GB

Q80: Can the turnaround times be shared for DR?

A80: We will share as part of the project initiation

Q81: What sources will fall under HIPPA and CJIS standards? What is currently being done?

A81: We will identify as part of the project

